

June 1, 2026

Cindy Duong — Principal
Cleveland Charter High School (LAUSD)
8140 Vanalden Ave, Reseda, CA 91335
cindy.duong@lausd.net
(818) 885-2300

Dear Principal Duong,

I am applying for the math teaching position at Cleveland Charter High School for the 2026-2027 school year. I bring a BSc in Mathematics and Computer Science from Brown, fifteen years as a software engineer at Apple, Cisco, and Goldman Sachs, and five years founding and teaching at Dragon and Crane Dojo — a small private school I built from the ground up. I am turning toward LAUSD because I want to spend the next phase of my work in a public school classroom serving the families I most want to serve.

High school is when students start projecting forward toward careers, and the math conversation finally gets honest. I have spent fifteen years inside that conversation as a working engineer, and I want to bring it back into the classroom intact — failures, redirects, and eventual wins included. At Dragon and Crane I have already done the work of writing and self-publishing my own curriculum, sequencing multi-year arcs in chess, coding, and physics, and tracking individual student progress, so the lesson-design and classroom-management muscles are not theoretical.

The industry background also lets me answer the question every math student eventually asks — when am I going to use this? I have used it: settlement systems at Goldman Sachs, network management APIs at Apple, clinical AI infrastructure at Deep6 AI. Math was not preparation for those jobs; it was the substance of them, and I want Cleveland students to hear that from someone who has lived inside the answer.

Thank you for your consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I can best serve Cleveland's students and families.

Sincerely,

David Chung
david.h.chung@gmail.com
(747) 333-6050